



Scorching Sorrows

Burn your problems. Literally.

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1.0 VERSION HISTORY

Version	Date	Description
1.0	10/05/25	Initial Doc
2.0	23/05/25	Added Overview, Story & Setting, Development Risks, gameplay and game progression.
3.0	14/06/25	Added gameplay loop, added level 1 top-down, added detail about story, Filled out controls and mechanics.
4.0	19/06/25	Filled out UI, audio and feedback sections.



2.0 OVERVIEW

2.1 Specifications

Official Name	Scorching Sorrows
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Genre	Interactive Narrative, Exploration, Relaxing
Theme	Burning things with fire, letting go, emotional pain/grief
Perspective	3D, First-Person, 360° Camera View
Game Engine	Unreal Engine v5.4.4
Age Rating	13+
Target Audience	15+ / Young Adults (some deep and mature themes explored)
Platforms	PC + Controller Support
Players	Single-Player

2.2 Elevator Pitch

Burn your problems. Literally.

2.3 Game Concept

A 3d experimental, narrative-driven exploration game centered around burning things on fire to solve our problems in life.

2.4 Unique Selling Points

- ❖ Unique combination of visuals, audio and mechanics that is done in a way that hasn't really been done or fully explored before.
- ❖ Unique gameplay experience and portrayal of the feelings of heartbreak and grief that can resonate with a lot of people.
- ❖ Ambient and atmospheric art style and environments that are appealing to look at and greatly emphasize the emotions being evoked.



3.0 GAMEPLAY

3.1 Objectives

1. Burn everything to 100% completion.
2. Go through all 5 stages of grief.
3. Unfold the interwoven narrative

3.2 Game Progression

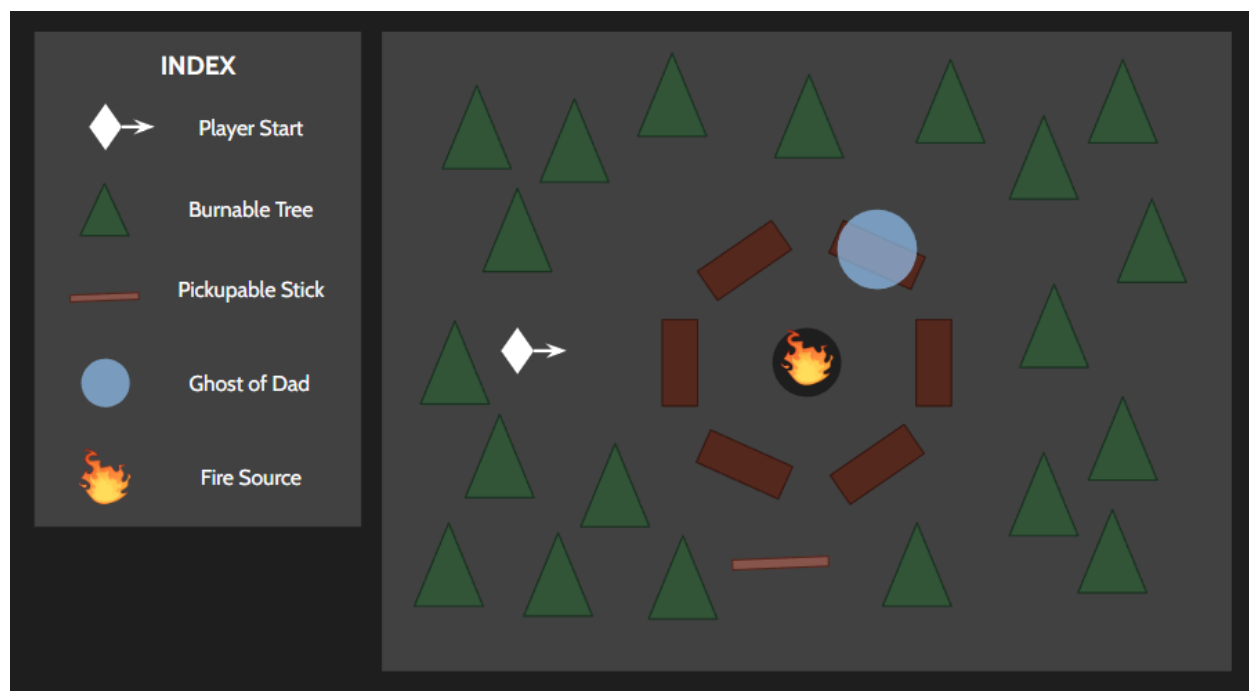
The player progresses through the game linearly, starting at level 1 (Denial) and ending on level 5 (Acceptance).



3.2.1 Levels

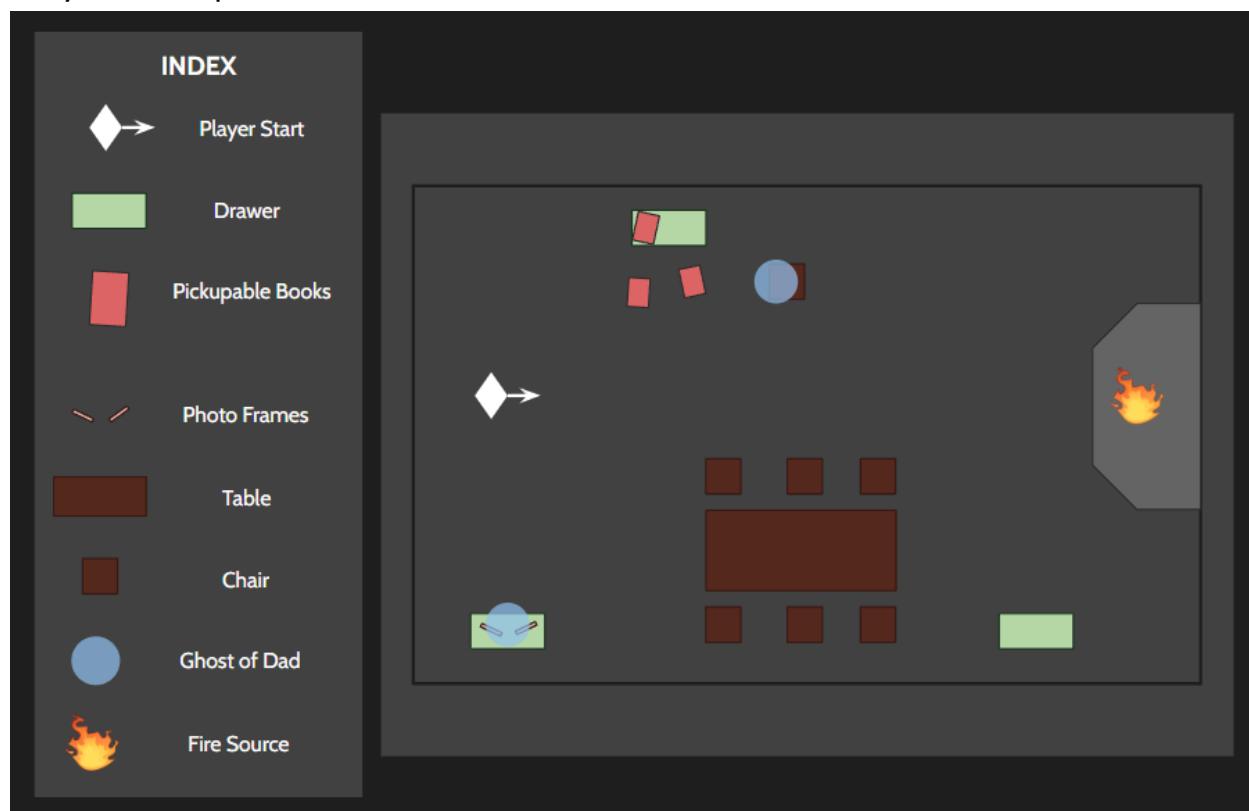
Level 1 Denial

Set in a campfire setting, burning the memories, both good and bad.



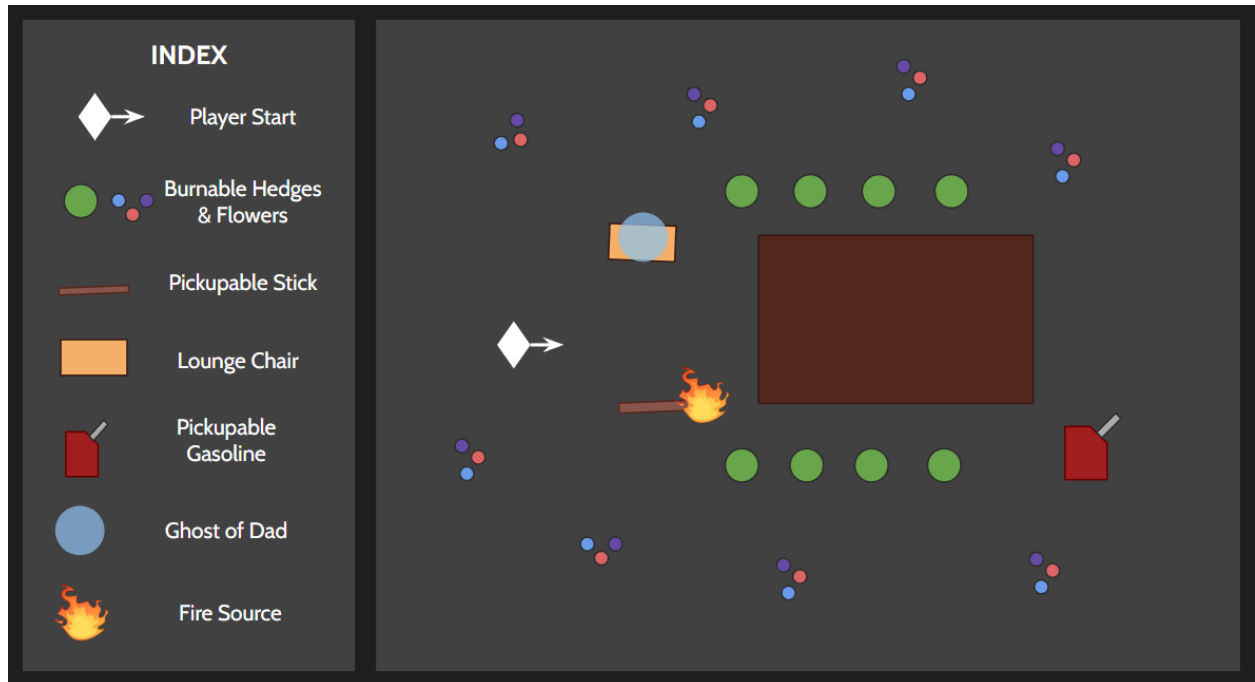
Level 2 Anger

Set in the family's house, with personal books and belongings, lashing out on external things to try to rid the pain.



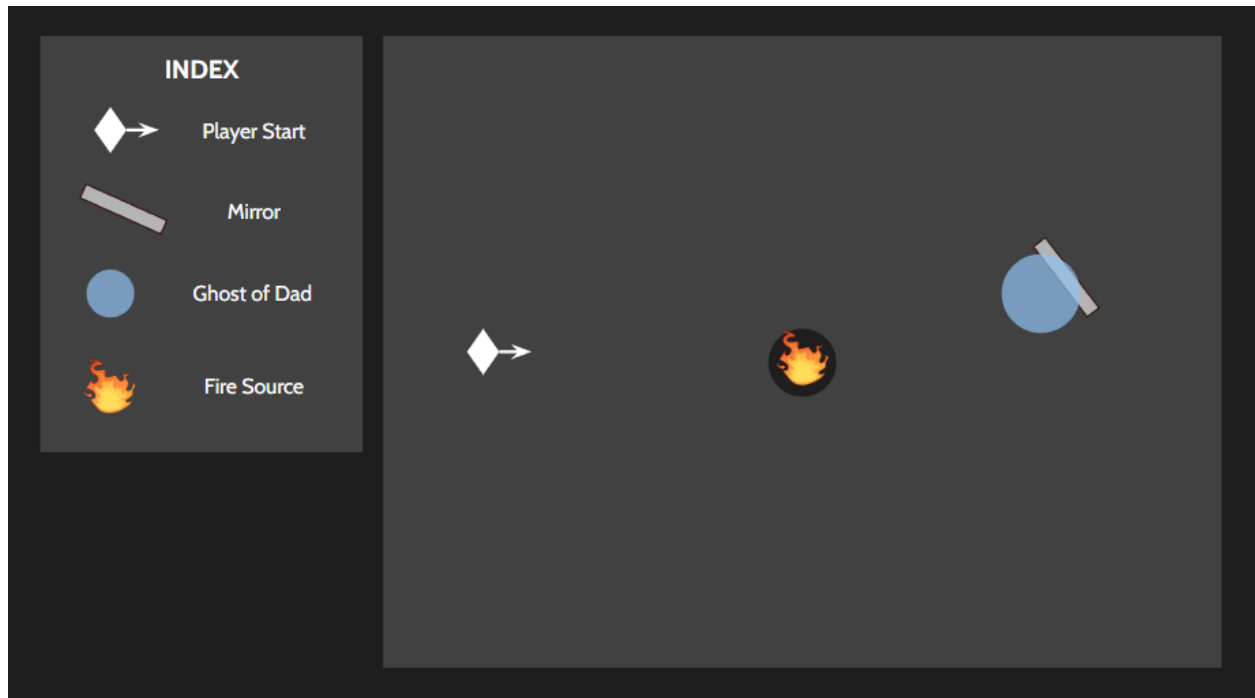
Level 3 Bargaining

Set outside the family home, feelings of hopelessness, with so many what ifs and regrets, you burn the one thing left stable in your life, your home itself.



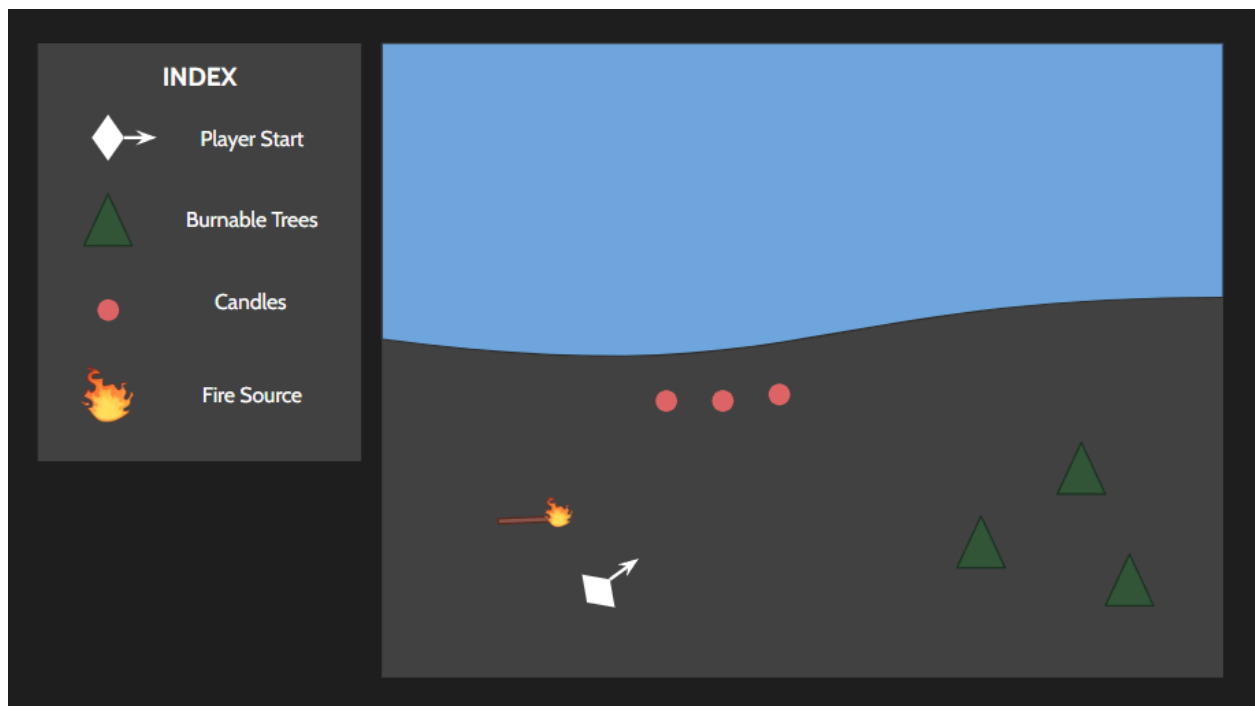
Level 4 Depression

Set outside back in the forest..you think? There is immense amounts of fog so you are unsure. Burning the family home, leaves you..homeless, and alone, with your thoughts. What else is there to burn.. Except.. Yourself?

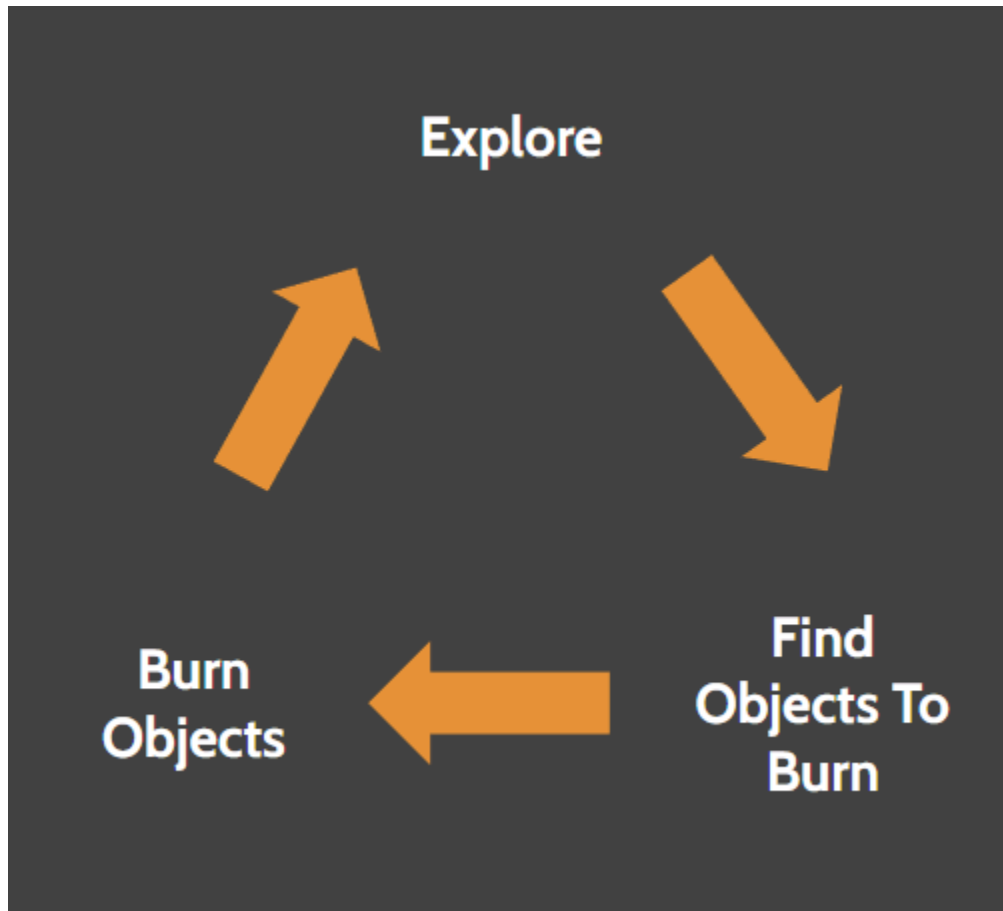


Level 5 Acceptance

Set outside the fog forest, at the seaside, you can choose to accept peace, or choose to stay in rage and misery in the world. The choice is yours.



3.3 Gameplay Loops



3.4 Player Experience

The main motivators for the player to progress through the levels is to satisfy a burning desire to burn everything to 100% completion, and to unfold and piece together the narrative woven in each level.

The fun factor comes from the game as a whole being therapeutic and a bit of an outlet to let out their frustrations, and wreak havoc onto something that they would normally not get the opportunity to (or at least, really *should not* do) do otherwise.



4.0 MECHANICS

4.1 Movement

The player is able to freely move around the environment, including jumping and sprinting.

4.2 Pick Up/Put Down

The player is able to pick up and put down specific objects. The objects the player is able to pick up are highlighted with a white outline when they come within range.

4.3 Fire

Within each level there is a fire source. The player is able to bring objects to fire, set it on fire and then proceed to spread that fire around the environment.



5.0 STORY & SETTING

5.1 Synopsis

Scorching Sorrows explores the theme of heartbreak and grief and the kinds of thoughts and feelings one might have during each stage of grief. Its story is kept somewhat vague, in order to let players interpret it and resonate with it in ways which fit within their lives, but at its core explores the story of a grieving daughter, mourning the loss of her dad.

In a desperate attempt to fix your problems and to take away the pain you feel, you've resorted to burning everything and anything in your sight, in hopes that it makes you feel better. Well go on then, burn it.. burn it *all*. Find out if it really helps..*or just makes things worse*.

5.2 Setting

Scorching Sorrows is set in modern day times, mostly in a natural forest environment, and each level consists of a different environment that the player has to burn down entirely. Each

level environment contains a different memory relating back to the daughter and her dad, memories which now only bring her pain.

5.3 Characters

The Daughter

There is a vague indication that the Player is the grown up daughter of the ghostly blue man they constantly see appear throughout each level. It is shown that they had a close bond and relationship through life, and the death of their dad has had a severe affect on them, shown through visual imagery of panic attacks and anxiety. Much else outside of this is left to the Player's interpretation.

The Dad

In each level, a blue ghostly figure can be seen, almost haunting the Player as they progress. This is the dad of the Player's character, and has recently died from a tragic accident. The figure is left a bit vague and not concretely a Dad to further leave who this mysterious person is up to interpretation, so players are able to resonate and connect with the loss in their own lives.



6.0 ART STYLE & AESTHETIC

The overall art style and aesthetic of Scorching Sorrows will lean more into a 3d low poly, fantasy nature art style, while still being semi-realistic, especially with visual effects. It will utilise natural colours, tones, lighting.. And err on the side of being believable, realistic and heavily immersive to the player, as if they are exploring the environments and going through this themselves.

Asset List -

 **Scorching Sorrows Timeline/Asset List**



7.0 INTERFACE

7.1 Menus

Scorching Sorrows

**Main
Menu**

Start Journey

Settings

Credits

Go Home

Live level
playing in
background

**Pause
Menu**

Blurred
background

Continue

Main Menu

**Settings
Menu**



Settings

SFX



Ambience

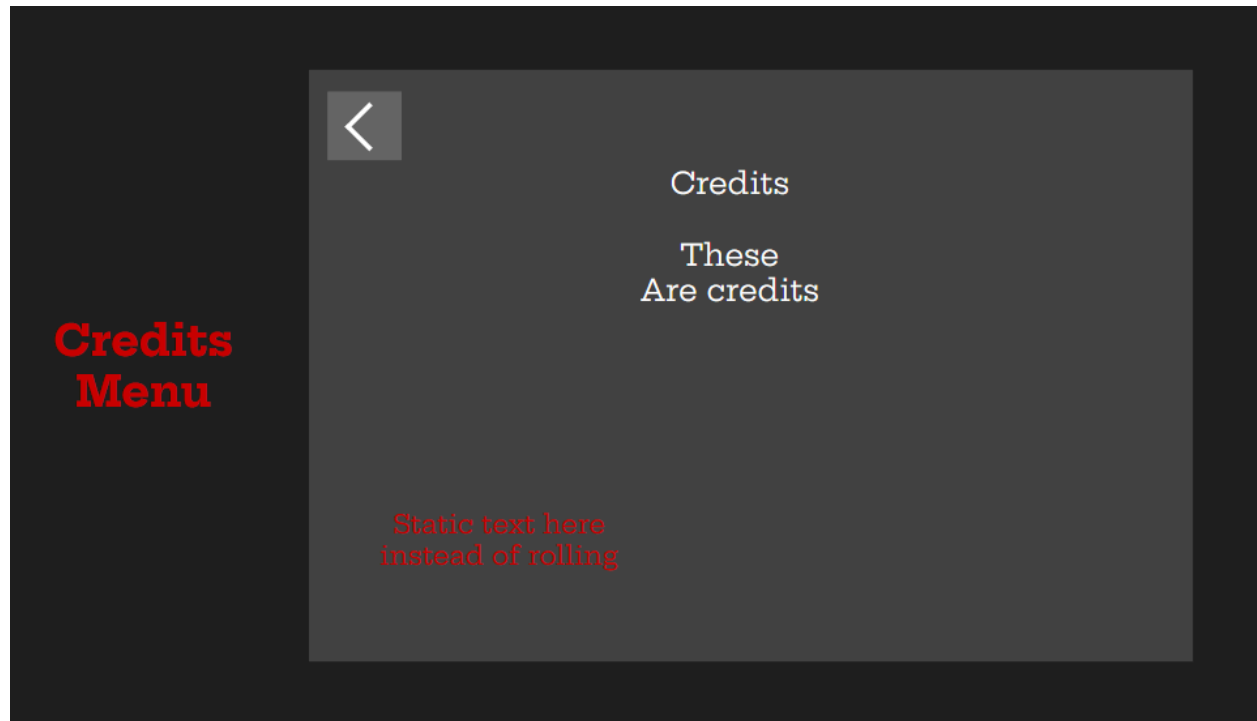


Graphics

< Low >

Resolution

< 1080x1920 >



7.2 Camera

The camera in Scorching Sorrows is in first-person mode and the player is able to freely move it around in all directions.

7.3 Controls

Action	Function
WASD Keys	Movement
Spacebar	Jump
Hold Shift	Sprint
Left Click (while holding object)	Release Object
Right Click (on object)	Pickup Object

7.4 Audio

Audio in Scorching Sorrows will be based around peaceful environmental ambience, that amplifies immersion for the player and retells some of the story through audio cues. It will automatically play as the player explores through the level and interacts with objects.

Background Music

Background music in Scorching Sorrows will not exist as it takes away the peaceful calm of the environments.

Background Ambience

Background ambience will be heavily emphasised upon and used heavily to evoke some kind of emotion or feeling through the use of sound. It will include things like the weather, rustling leaves, fire crackling, wind howling, creaking of the house..etc.

Sound Effects

Sound effects will be realistic sounding and used to further add to the ambience of each environment or go towards retelling the narrative of the game. Sometimes these sound effects will appear in unexpected places, to add to the unusual and strange factor of the game, where it audibly shows the player what their character is thinking/feeling in each given moment. Sometimes these sound effects are intended to break the peacefulness of the ambience, further emphasising an emotion or feeling.



9.0 DEVELOPMENT

9.1 The Team

The development of this game is purely solo, and thus consists of just one developer and the client.

Client

Jin Chan Yum Wai

Programmer & Designer

Naomi Kendall

Artist

Unreal Asset Store

9.2 Potential Risks

RISK	SEVERITY	LIKELINESS	MITIGATION STRAT
Too Many Art Assets	Medium	Likely	Reduce
Miscommunication Of Game Concept	Medium	Very Likely	Reduce
Losing all our work	High	Probable	Avoid
Overscoping With Ideas/Levels	Medium	Very Likely	Avoid
Frustrating Puzzles/Mechanics	Medium	Probable	Reduce

9.3 Delivery Milestones

See timeline for schedule and expected completion of milestones here -

 **Scorching Sorrows Timeline**

9.4 Feedback

First Meeting - Discussed removing the idea of having a progress bar of how much of the environment they've burnt, as would break immersion, and instead just have it all visual. And also if 5 levels was realistically feasible within the timeframe.

Second Meeting - Discussed trying to achieve spreadable fire when objects with fire hit unlit objects.

Third Meeting - Discussed just general progress and if on the right track to completion.

9.5 Production Software

ART

Fab Asset Store - *The game will utilise free assets as much as possible*

PROGRAMMING

Unreal Engine 5.4.4 - *The chosen game engine for my project.*

Perforce - *The chosen software for source control of my project.*

SOUND

Soundsnap - *Source of free sounds we will use within the project.*

Audacity - *Used to mix and master the sounds to manipulate them how I want them for the project.*

Pixabay - *Another source of free sounds I will use to source sound assets.*

ORGANISATION

Google Sheets - *Used for gantt chart scheduling, milestone planning and also the asset list.*

Google Slides - *Used for creating the concept pitch presentation and for making mockups of things such as UI and top-down views.*

Teams - *Professional line of communication, and file sharing.*

